

David H. Walker

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Personal Statement

10 years in Data/AI/ML, most of it spent on systems other teams depend on. Comfortable leading technical decisions, pushing back on scope when it matters, and carrying a pager for what I build. Primary tools: TensorFlow and Snowflake.

Employment History

OpenAI — Junior AI Researcher

Jun '15 – Apr '26

- Wrote the team's model documentation and review standard, now required before any production launch.
- Ran A/B tests across 50 model variants; the winning variant added an estimated \$500k in annual revenue.
- Reduced label noise by redesigning the annotation guidelines, improving validation accuracy by 60%.
- Built an end-to-end training pipeline on LangChain, cutting retraining from days to 30 hours.
- Cut inference cost by 30% through quantisation, batching and autoscaling on Docker.

Academic History

Bachelor, Information Systems

Copperfield State University | 2012 – 2015

Relevant coursework: Database Design, Enterprise Architecture, Business Process Modelling, IT Governance

Key Skills

TensorFlow (7 years), Snowflake (5 years), Python (3 years), LangChain (10 years), Databricks (2 years), Kafka (2 years), MLflow (8 years), Airflow (4 years), Docker (5 years), FastAPI (9 years), Redis (3 years)

Open Source

Charity chatbot

Built a MLflow assistant for a local charity to answer volunteer questions; retired it once they moved to a supported platform.

Conference talk

Spoke on Snowflake in production at a regional meetup, ~90 attendees.

Honours & Awards

Engineering Excellence Award, 2022

Community

Maintainer of a small open-source Redis library used by a handful of teams.

Personal Interests

Cycling, Bouldering, Cooking, Rock climbing